

Sarayu Ramnath

Santa Barbara, CA | [LinkedIn](#)

Environmental researcher and coordinator specializing in conservation science, data visualization, and science communication.

EDUCATION

Master of Environmental Science and Management (June 2026)

Bren School of Environmental Science & Management – University of California, Santa Barbara

Bachelor of Science, Animal Science, & Chemistry Minor (March 2017)

California State Polytechnic University, Pomona

EXPERIENCE

Program Research Consultant & Coordinator | Conservation International, Santa Barbara, CA (06/26-9/26)

- Coordinate delivery of a grant-funded climate vulnerability assessment across 6 Eastern Tropical Pacific countries and 3 taxonomic workstreams, managing project milestones, outputs, and reporting deliverables.
- Coordinate collaboration with 10+ researchers, conservation managers, and partner organizations across institutions and countries, managing data-sharing agreements, data access and use discussions, cross-disciplinary workflows, regional workshop planning, and research capacity-building.
- Facilitate meetings across collaborators, building alignment around research priorities, data contributions, modeling approaches, and conservation applications.
- Develop 3 technical briefs and science-to-policy products synthesizing climate vulnerability, species distribution modeling, and conservation priorities for 11 marine megafauna species.
- Support analytical workflows through dataset compilation, climate model evaluation, spatial analyses, and development of reproducible R/Shiny tools.

Graduate Research Associate | Conservation International, Santa Barbara, CA (11/24–06/26)

- Co-authored 40 page climate vulnerability assessment for 11 marine megafauna species in the Eastern Tropical Pacific, synthesizing life history, climate exposure, and anthropogenic pressures to inform regional conservation and management recommendations.
- Helped organize and facilitate project climate modelers' workshop, bringing together international researchers and conservation practitioners to share modeling approaches, discuss data needs, and strengthen collaboration around regional climate vulnerability assessments.
- Developed spatial vulnerability analyses and data workflows to support species distribution modeling, including dataset acquisition, data use agreements, habitat suitability analyses, and climate impact mapping.

Co-Project Manager & Co-Data Manager | Environmental Baseline Assessment of Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary, Master's Group Capstone, Bren School, UCSB, Santa Barbara, CA (4/25 – 6/26)

- Co-managed an interdisciplinary environmental baseline assessment for Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary, coordinating project workflows, timelines, data management, and reporting deliverables with sanctuary staff, scientific collaborators, and capstone team members.
- Collaborated with sanctuary staff and external experts to synthesize ecological, oceanographic, and human-relationship information into evidence-based conservation and management recommendations.
- Consolidated and analyzed multi-decadal biodiversity datasets, including 30+ years of seabird and marine mammal survey data, to evaluate spatial and temporal patterns in species richness.
- Developed reproducible data workflows using R, GitHub, and Quarto; organized metadata, analytical methods, and documentation to support transparent data stewardship.
- Co-authored a 150 page assessment report and created publication-ready spatial visualizations and technical communication products using R and ArcGIS to support scientific reporting and public-facing materials for technical and non-technical audiences.
- Recruited and mentored 1 undergraduate data intern, supporting skill development in environmental data management and analysis.

SARAYU RAMNATH PAGE 2**EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)****Science Communication Consultant | UC Santa Barbara Natural Reserve System (UCSB NRS), Santa Barbara, CA (3/26–6/26)**

- Developed 1 infographic, 4 data visualizations, and reproducible Quarto reporting workflow translating UCSB Natural Reserve System metrics on research, education, and public engagement into accessible communication products for public and partner audiences.
- Translated technical data into accessible products while maintaining reproducible documentation and clear pathways between underlying data, analysis, and public-facing communication.
- Collaborated with reserve directors and partners to contextualize quantitative metrics with qualitative insights and on-the-ground perspectives, ensuring communications accurately reflected program impact.

Channel Islands Marine Debris Cleanup Coordinator | National Marine Sanctuary Foundation (NMSF), Ventura, CA (8/23–12/23)

- Coordinated Channel Islands marine debris cleanup efforts in collaboration with NOAA Channel Islands National Marine Sanctuary (CINMS) staff, fishermen, and local partners to support place-based stewardship.
- Worked across partners with different institutional roles and perspectives, supporting shared priorities, communication, logistics, and implementation of cleanup efforts.
- Managed project logistics, partnership communication, and reporting materials documenting cleanup activities and outcomes for NMSF, CINMS, and NOAA Office of National Marine Sanctuaries.
- Collaborated with partner organizations to adopt an ArcGIS-based marine debris cleanup tracking system, contributing cleanup data and training partners to use the platform and follow data-logging protocols.

Social Media Coordinator; Marine Ecology Research Assistant | Point Blue Conservation Science | California, USA & Baja California, MX (2017–2022)

- Translated conservation research into public-facing communications through digital outreach, newsletters, and storytelling across multiple science programs.
- Managed and analyzed long-term ecological monitoring datasets spanning 20+ years of marine predator research and 60+ years of seabird monitoring across 13 research projects using Microsoft Access, Excel, and standardized data protocols.
- Conducted field research and ecological analyses across California and Baja California Sur, supporting marine conservation assessments, seabird population monitoring, and management reports for regional partners.
- Collaborated with Mexico-based researchers and conservation partners to coordinate cross-border shorebird research, aligning data collection approaches and supporting regional species assessments.
- Trained and supervised volunteers in standardized ecological data collection and processing protocols, supporting research continuity and data quality.

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS, FACILITATION, AND KNOWLEDGE EXCHANGE**CalCOFI Conference, San Diego, California – May 2026***Oceanography and Marine Megafauna in Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary (poster)***American Geophysical Union, New Orleans, Louisiana – December 2025***Antiracist, Decolonial, Intersectional Praxis: Reflections from the Field (poster)***Center for Alaskan Coastal Studies, Homer, Alaska – August 2025***Collaborative Research and Public Data to Understand a Dynamic Pacific (talk)***UC Santa Barbara Environmental Studies/ Environmental Justice Alliance—January 2025***Resilience and Resistance: Current Topics Panel (Moderator)***SKILLS****Project and Data Management:** Asana, Git/GitHub, Microsoft Access, R/RStudio, Quarto, reproducible workflows, metadata organization, environmental data management, meeting and workshop facilitation.**Scientific Communication & Outreach:** Technical writing, report development, data visualization, Adobe Premiere, Affinity Designer, Mailchimp, Zotero.**GIS & Spatial Analysis:** ArcGIS, QGIS, habitat suitability modeling, spatial vulnerability mapping, climate impact analyses